Parekh wrote the examination twice more but the coveted letter of appointment failed to come his way. It was a bitter pill to swallow. Parekh then enrolled at the London School of Economics for a BSc (Banking and Finance) which he completed in three years. He was Secretary of the India Society at the London School of Economics and this was where the shy and introverted Parekh learnt the art of public speaking. Later in life, Parekh gave innumerable speeches where this early training must have stood him in good stead. But essentially Parekh remained a man of few and simple words, uttered in a subdued tone.

Dantwala writing after Parekh's demise in 1994 said that this trait was significant since it showed that he was concerned with communicating his ideas and sharing his thoughts rather than impressing others with his erudition or style. 'The softness of his expression did not mean he had no definite or even strong views, I know he had, on many economic issues under public debate. But he did not believe that strong views must necessarily be expressed in strong words or loudly. Their strength lies in the thinker's intellectual integrity. Strong words vanish quickly; sound thoughts have a longer life. That must have been his conviction.'[5] As Ashok Mitra observed on Parekh's passing away, 'His civilisation lay in the economy as much of diction as of his gestures.'[6] Deepak Satwalekar, who was the Managing Director of HDFC from 1993 to 2000, put it succinctly when he said: '…The first thing you learnt about H.T. Parekh was that you did not need to be loud to be heard. You did not need to be flashy to be noticed…'[7]

Parekh, as we have already noted before, also made the acquaintance of Sir Sorabji Pochkhanawala in England, helping him with secretarial work. After returning to India in 1936, Parekh began his financial career with a leading stock broking firm, Harkisondass Lukhmidass. It would have been simple to join the Central Bank of India where his father and elder brother Shantilal were employed. But Parekh wanted to do something different. Parekh chanced upon an advertisement in the newspaper where Harkisondass Lukhmidass were inviting applications from qualified young men. Harkisondass asked Parekh for a reference and Parekh gave Sir Purshotamdas Thakurdas's name. When asked, Purshotamdas strongly endorsed Parekh's candidature. Parekh appears to have interacted with Purshotamdas quite frequently. Harsha Parekh, his niece recalls her uncle